



Tsukumogami

Japanese folktales are littered with these creepy, household object spirits. Learn more about them here! <http://digit.in/jan21-91>



Movie Titles with Household Items

Using the simplest and most straightforward movie titles, is sometimes the best way to get your message across. <http://digit.in/jan21-92>



Household items named after people

Here are just some of the things that we encounter on a daily basis that are named after the people who invented them.

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Credit: cmog.org



Mason jar named after John Landis Mason

The French chef, Nicolas Appert invented the method of preserving food in glass jars sealed with wax in the early 1800s. It was a messy procedure that involved working with liquid wax. In 1858, John Landis Mason improved the design by using a thread top lid and a rubber ring, and sold it as a waterproof and airproof container. He patented it and so many were made that "Mason's Patent November 28th 1858" are still common. Unfortunately for Mason, he patented only the threaded lid and not the rubber ring, and spent the rest of his life trying to get the money for his invention, and ultimately died penniless.



Petri dish named after Julius Richard Petri

Julius Richard Petri was a German microbiologist working for Robert Koch, who was investigating the microorganisms that spread diseases. To study various bacteria it was necessary to make cultures of them and grow them in a lab environment. Julius Richard Petri developed the standard way to do this using shallow glass dishes containing agar and nutrients in 1877. The approach was so effective that it continues to be used today. By a happy accident, in 1929, Alexander Flemming noticed that mold had killed bacterial culture in a Petri dish leading to the first antibiotic, penicillin.



Credit: NYT



Rubik's cube named after Erno Rubik

The most popular toy in the world was invented in 1974 by Erno Rubik, a Hungarian architect while he was looking for ways to explain 3D movement to his students. Rubik spent months developing various models made up of blocks of wood and paper, that were held together by gym, rubber bands, and paper clips. It was originally named the "bűvös kocka" or the magic cube. This might seem like a rudimentary hack, but the cube was solid and functional and was essentially the same design used even today. The reception surprised the creator the most, who has explained the entire process in the book 'Cubed: The Puzzle of Us All'.

